

KEY DATA

Size ranking 13
Brightest stars Arcturus (α)
-0.1, Izar (ε) 2.4
Genitive Boötis
Abbreviation Boo
Highest in sky at 10pm
May–June
Fully visible 90°N–35°S



CHART 5

MAIN STARS

Arcturus Alpha (α) Boötis
Orange giant
☼ -0.1 ↔ 37 light-years

Nekkar Beta (β) Boötis
Yellow giant
☼ 3.5 ↔ 225 light-years

Seginus Gamma (γ) Boötis
White giant; also a variable star
☼ 3.0 ↔ 87 light-years

Delta (δ) Boötis
Yellow giant; also a double star
☼ 3.5 ↔ 122 light-years

Izar Epsilon (ε) Boötis
Orange giant; also a double star
☼ 2.4 ↔ 202 light-years

Muphrid Eta (η) Boötis
Yellow subgiant
☼ 2.7 ↔ 37 light-years

Alkalurops Mu (μ) Boötis
White main-sequence star; also a triple star
☼ 4.3 ↔ 113 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

NGC 5248
Spiral galaxy

NGC 5466
Globular cluster

NGC 5548
Lenticular galaxy; also a Seyfert galaxy

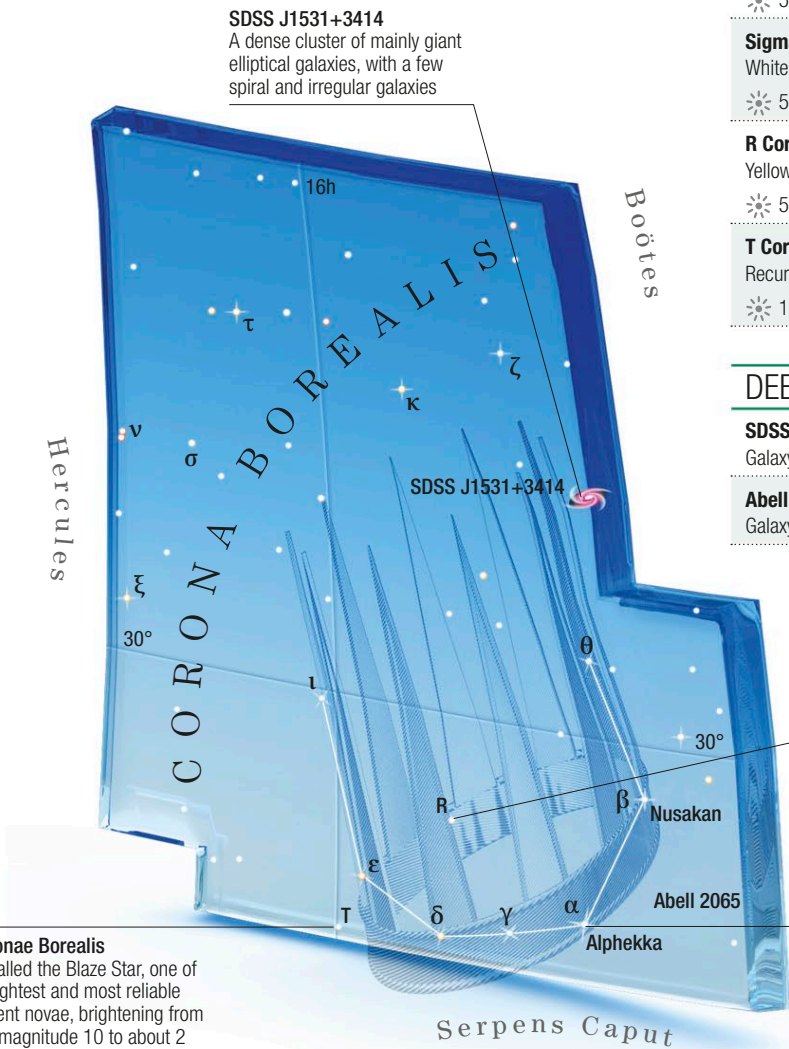
NGC 5676
Spiral galaxy

NGC 5752 and NGC 5754
Pair of interacting galaxies

CORONA BOREALIS
THE NORTHERN CROWN

A HORSESHOE-SHAPED PATTERN OF STARS REPRESENTING A MAGNIFICENT CROWN, CORONA BOREALIS IS A SMALL BUT DISTINCTIVE CONSTELLATION IN THE NORTHERN SKY.

One of the original 48 constellations of ancient Greece, Corona Borealis represents the jewel-studded crown worn by the mythical Princess Ariadne of Crete at her wedding to the god Dionysus. Newly married, Dionysus tossed the crown into the sky, where its jewels became stars. The crown shape is drawn around seven linked stars. Found between Boötes and Hercules, it is easily spotted despite the relative faintness of its stars. Corona Borealis contains interesting double stars and variables. It is also host to several galaxy clusters, including SDS J1531+3414 and Abell 2065. The latter contains more than 400 galaxies but is 1.5 billion light-years away and is too faint to be visible with most amateur telescopes.



SDSS J1531+3414
A dense cluster of mainly giant elliptical galaxies, with a few spiral and irregular galaxies

KEY DATA

Size ranking 73
Brightest stars Alphekka (α)
2.1–2.3, Nusakan (β) 3.7
Genitive Coronae Borealis
Abbreviation CrB
Highest in sky at 10pm
June
Fully visible 90°N–50°S

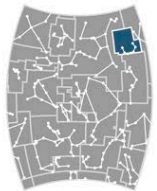


CHART 4

MAIN STARS

Alphekka Alpha (α) Coronae Borealis
White main-sequence star; also an eclipsing binary
☼ 2.1–2.3 ↔ 75 light-years

Nusakan Beta (β) Coronae Borealis
White main-sequence star; also a binary
☼ 3.7 ↔ 112 light-years

Gamma (γ) Coronae Borealis
White main-sequence star
☼ 3.8 ↔ 146 light-years

Zeta (ζ) Coronae Borealis
Blue-white main-sequence star; also a double star
☼ 4.9 ↔ 470 light-years

Nu (ν) Coronae Borealis
Red giant; also a double star
☼ 5.2 ↔ 640 light-years

Sigma (σ) Coronae Borealis
White main-sequence star; also a double star
☼ 5.6 ↔ 69 light-years

R Coronae Borealis
Yellow supergiant; also a variable star
☼ 5.7 ↔ 81,500 light-years

T Coronae Borealis
Recurrent nova, also known as the Blaze Star
☼ 10.2 ↔ 3,470 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

SDSS J1531+3414
Galaxy cluster

Abell 2065
Galaxy cluster

R Coronae Borealis
A yellow supergiant usually just visible to the naked eye but which diminishes in brightness every few years to about magnitude 14

Alphekka (α Coronae Borealis)
An eclipsing binary varying in brightness between magnitudes 2.1 and 2.3 in a 17.4-day cycle

T Coronae Borealis
Also called the Blaze Star, one of the brightest and most reliable recurrent novae, brightening from about magnitude 10 to about 2 every few decades